Hassan Sayed

hsayed@cgdev.org ◦ https://www.hassan-sayed.com
Center for Global Development, 2055 L St NW Washington, D.C. 20036

Placement Director	Gianluca Violante	violante@princeton.edu	609-258-4003
Graduate Administrator	Laura Hedden	lhedden@princeton.edu	609-258-4006

Statement

I am a microeconomist who studies applications of economic theory to public policy, innovation, and political economy/organizations. I also hold public policy experience designing and implementing funding mechanisms that accelerate innovation in climate and public health.

Employment and Education

Postdoctoral Scholar, Market Shaping Accelerator 2025-

- Initiative of Center for Global Development, Dartmouth College, and University of Chicago; researched role of market shaping in stimulating innovation under Prof. Chris Snyder.
- Designed "pull funding" mechanisms to incentivize generic drug repurposing and development of low-cost chlorine sensors, and engaged with policymakers on implementation.

PhD in Economics, Princeton University 2019-25

- Advisors: Pietro Ortoleva, Leah Boustan.
- Fields: Economic Theory, Political Economy.
- Affiliations: Research Program in Political Economy, Economic Theory Center.

BA in Economics, Mathematics, MMSS, Northwestern University 2015-19

References

Letter Writers, Economics Job Market

Pietro Ortoleva
Department of Economics
Princeton University
pietro.ortoleva@princeton.edu

Christopher Snyder
Department of Economics
Dartmouth College
christopher.snyder@dartmouth.edu

Faruk Gul
Department of Economics
Princeton University
fgul@princeton.edu

Additional References

Leah Boustan
Department of Economics
Yale University
leah.boustan@yale.edu

Gleason Judd
Department of Politics
Princeton University
gleason.judd@princeton.edu

Leah Rosenzweig
Market Shaping Accelerator
Center for Global Development
lrosenzweig@cgdev.org

Job Market Paper

"Communicating with Models and Data."

Many real-world decisions rely on external data collection and modeling: consultants provide clients scenarios, fund managers present models of asset returns, and AI chatbots offer recommendations based on internal data. I study how model simplification in these settings distorts not just how data are interpreted but also which data are collected. A sender collects data and estimates a model that helps a receiver make a choice. The sender's model is simple in that it artificially restricts the curvature of the relationship between choices and outcomes: a "naive" model understates curvature and neglects tradeoffs between costs and benefits, while a "cautious" model overstates curvature and exaggerates them. I show that estimating simple models creates strategic incentives to collect data poorly suited to the receiver's decision. Senders who estimate naive models sample data about an excessively large range of choices, while those who estimate cautious models sample locally around a single extreme choice. With multiple variables, senders sample data that maximize collinearity across variables. These distortions make model simplicity strategically valuable: senders who estimate accurate models benefit when receivers misperceive their models as naive or cautious. In equilibrium, accurate senders surround themselves with simple senders who polarize into two groups: those who estimate maximally naive and maximally cautious models. In the limit, these correspond to linear regressions and "worst-case scenario" models, respectively.

Publications

1. "Learning Traps." June 2026. **Forthcoming, American Journal of Political Science**.
2. "Transatlantic Technologies: The Role of ICT in the Evolution of U.S. and European Productivity Growth." With Robert J. Gordon. *International Productivity Monitor No. 38*, Spring 2020.
3. "The Industry Anatomy of the Transatlantic Productivity Growth Slowdown: Europe Chasing the American Frontier." With Robert J. Gordon. *International Productivity Monitor No. 37*, Fall 2019.

Working Papers

1. "Optimal Push and Pull Funding for Innovation." With Chris Snyder. September 2026.
2. "Persuasion with Partisanship: The Informational Content of Policymaking with Application to US Governors." June 2026. **Under review**.
3. "Misconduct in Organizations." With Kim Sarnoff. June 2026. **Under review**
4. "The Twin Puzzles of U.S. Productivity Growth Dynamics: A New Interpretation." With Robert J. Gordon. November 2025. NBER WP 30267, CEPR DP19569.

Selected Work in Progress

1. "Valence and Candidate Differentiation in Elections." Slides available upon request.
2. "Model-Based Inference: An Experimental Approach." With Kim Sarnoff.

3. "Evaluating Pull Funding: Evidence from Sensors for In-Line Chlorination."

Policy and Public Writing

1. "Response to FDA RFI: Generic Drug Repurposing Incentive Program Proposal." With Chris Snyder, Akhil Bansal, and Sarrin Chethik. Submitted to FDA RFI: Drug Repurposing for Unmet Medical Needs, July 2026.
2. "Transatlantic technologies: Why did the ICT revolution fail to boost European productivity growth?" With Robert J. Gordon. *VoxEU*, August 2020.
3. "The industry anatomy of the transatlantic productivity growth slowdown: Similarities outweigh the differences." With Robert J. Gordon. *VoxEU*, August 2019.

Teaching

Princeton	SPI 511b: Microeconomic Analysis for Policymakers (TA, Fall 2024)
Northwestern	MATH 220: Single-Variable Calculus (TA: Fall 2016) MATH 224: Single-Variable Integral Calculus (TA: Winter 2017, Fall 2017) MATH 230: Multivariable Calculus (TA: Spring 2018, Winter 2019)

Fellowships, Grants, and Honors

Alfred P. Sloan Foundation 2025-27
Amount: $966,417 (part of grant 2025-25183 to Chris Snyder, Dartmouth College)

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship 2019–24
Amount: $102,000

Research Program in Political Economy Grant, Princeton 2024
Amount: $2,000

William S. Dietrich II Economic Theory Center Research Grant 2022-24
Amount: $3,900 ($\times$ 3 years)

Princeton University Graduate Fellowship 2019-21

Frederick S. Deibler Award for Distinguished Honors Thesis, Northwestern 2019

Interdisciplinary Honors, Northwestern 2019

Phi Beta Kappa, Northwestern 2019

Other Research Experience

Research Assistant, Prof. Roland Bénabou (Princeton) 2022

Research Assistant, Prof. Robert J. Gordon (Northwestern) 2017-19

Professional Activities

Presentations

2027 North American Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (Sched.)

2026 Midwest Theory Conference (Sched.), Center for Global Development, Stony Brook Game Theory, Midwest Political Science Association, Dartmouth College, International Industrial Organization Conference

2025 European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Stony Brook Game Theory, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy

2024 Princeton Industrial Relations Seminar, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy

2023 North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy

2022 Association for Comparative Economic Studies, Princeton Microeconomic Theory, Princeton Political Economy, Young Economist Symposium

2021 Princeton Microeconomic Theory

Referee Services

American Economic Review

Skills and Activities

Languages	English, Urdu; MATLAB, Python, STATA
Citizenship	United States
Activities	Princeton Lawrence Apartments Committee (Secretary 2021-22, President 2022-24); Adobe Creative Suite; Professional Photography

Last updated: October 2026